Longkhor Conical Basket Craft

Resource Identifier: CULT-TRAD-004

English Translation: Traditional Tangkhul Bamboo Basketry

Category: Tradition | Subcategory: Craft

Village / Region: Ukhrul | Dialect: Ukhrul

Contributor / Source: Tangkhul Bamboo Craftsmen (Traditional Craft (Hodson 1911))

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Seasonal Timing / Occasion: Year-round agricultural transport and harvest conveyance

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Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Artisanal hand-woven conical bamboo basket used with head tumpline for transporting paddy, firewood, and harvest produce across mountainous terrain.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Longkhorli ot phungda kaphungli chat, iram mibingwui pang."
"Kahao wui li shaihaida kachak, chanam tara phungda."
"Kaphung kongrei luishang kachida, Longkhor mashimanpaishap."

English Translation & Meaning:

"Carrying loads in the Longkhor basket across mountain trails, the steadfast companion of hill life."
"Woven tightly from mature mountain bamboo and cane, defying rain, weight, and wear."
"Across every terrace and steep mountain ridge, the Longkhor remains an indispensable tool."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Harvesting mature mountain bamboo (Kaha) and pliable cane during dry winter months.
2. Splitting bamboo into fine, uniform pliable strips (Lishing).
3. Weaving four-cornered conical base and expanding body with close twill weave.
4. Reinforcing rim with bent hardwood hoop and cane lashing.
5. Attaching woven head tumpline (Khangvai) for ergonomic mountain burden carrying.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Master Bamboo Craftsmen, Farmers, Mountain Villagers